A-A-53496
17 June 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SLING, HEAD

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers a flannel lined head sling which, in conjunction with a spreader bar and appropriate weights, provides cervical traction as needed.

Salient characteristics:

The head sling shall consist of a flannel lined chin and neck support which shall be provided in the following sizes:

Size 1	Large (suitable for a 12 inch spreader bar)
Size 2	Medium (suitable for a 12 inch spreader bar)
Size 3	Small (suitable for a 9 inch spreader bar)

The material of the chin and neck support shall consist of a cotton coutil or bleached jean backing having a minimum weight of 6 ounces per square yard, and a cotton flannel lining having a minimum weight of 4.6 ounces per square yard. A laminated flannel lined cotton material, equivalent to the above, shall be acceptable. Cotton webbing shall be used and shall be 3/4 inch wide with a minimum weight of 0.48 ounces per linear yard. The edges of the head sling shall be doubled over, or secured by a cotton binding having a minimum overall width of 1/2 inch and a minimum weight of 4 ounces per square yard.

AMSC N/A FSC 6530

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A corrosion-resisting steel or nickel plated steel adjustable slide bar shall be assembled to the webbing on each side of the head sling. The slide bar and hook shall have no sharp edges and shall be the quick-release type. Two corrosion-resisting steel or nickel plated steel "D" rings shall be furnished. The rings shall be capable of accepting an orthopedic style spreader bar.

Stitching shall be the lock stitch type, 6 to 10 stitches per inch. Thread shall be a soft nylon, size c, or equal. Where webbing meets the body of the head sling, there shall be a double row of stitching, a bar-tack or a box-stitch across the width of the webbing.

Thread breaks shall be back-stitched not less than 1/2 inch at each break. Stitching ends not caught in other seams or stitching shall be back-stitched not less than 1/4 inch. As an alternate, the backstitching pattern of box-stitching machines is acceptable. All thread ends shall be trimmed and removed. The thread tension shall be maintained so that there shall not be any loose or tight stitching.

The head sling shall support a minimum weight of 75 pounds, spread uniformly over the area between the stitching of the pad, without any visible evidence of damage.

The design of the head sling shall prevent pressure on the neck, carotid artery, or nerves.

The head sling shall not contain any stains, spots, non-specified holes, abraded areas, tears, cuts, mends, patches, scorches, or needle chews.

The head sling shall not have an objectionable odor.

Each head sling shall have a label that is colorfast to laundering. The labeling shall be permanently marked with the name or registered trademark of the manufacturer and the size of the head sling; small, medium, or large, as applicable.

Workmanship. The head sling shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One sling, of the size specified, constitutes one unit.

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Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one head sling as specified in this description.

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Defects.

Any component missing, misplaced, or not as specified.

Any operation omitted or not properly performed.

Color not as specified.

Not proper size.

Any mend, patch, burn or needle chew.

Wrong seam or stitch type.

Open seam, on joining seam and binding, more than 1/4 inch.

Raw edge, more than 1/2 inch.

Webbing or hardware not as specified.

Loose or tight stitching.

Objectionable odor.

Head sling not clean.

Abrasion marks, open places, broken or missing yarn, or multiple floats.

Stitching not uniformly gauged.

Thread breaks back-stitched less than 1/2 inch.

Incorrect number of stitches per inch.

Thread ends not trimmed throughout.

Label omitted, incorrect, or illegible.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests including dimensional test shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-1. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one head sling.

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Tests

Test for Fit. One head sling shall be placed on an individual's head. After adjustment of the straps, the head sling shall be examined for fit and compliance with the requirement to accept an orthopedic style spreader bar at the "D" rings. A poor fit or inability to accept a spreader bar shall constitute a defect.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

6530-00-926-9064 (size 1)
6530-00-926-9069 (size 2)
6530-00-926-9070 (size 3)

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-1994

PGC 05115

Location: CID/SLING/H13-31

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NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53496	SLING, HEAD

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION

b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*

4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*

- ☐ VENDOR
- ☐ USER
- ☐ MANUFACTURER
- ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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